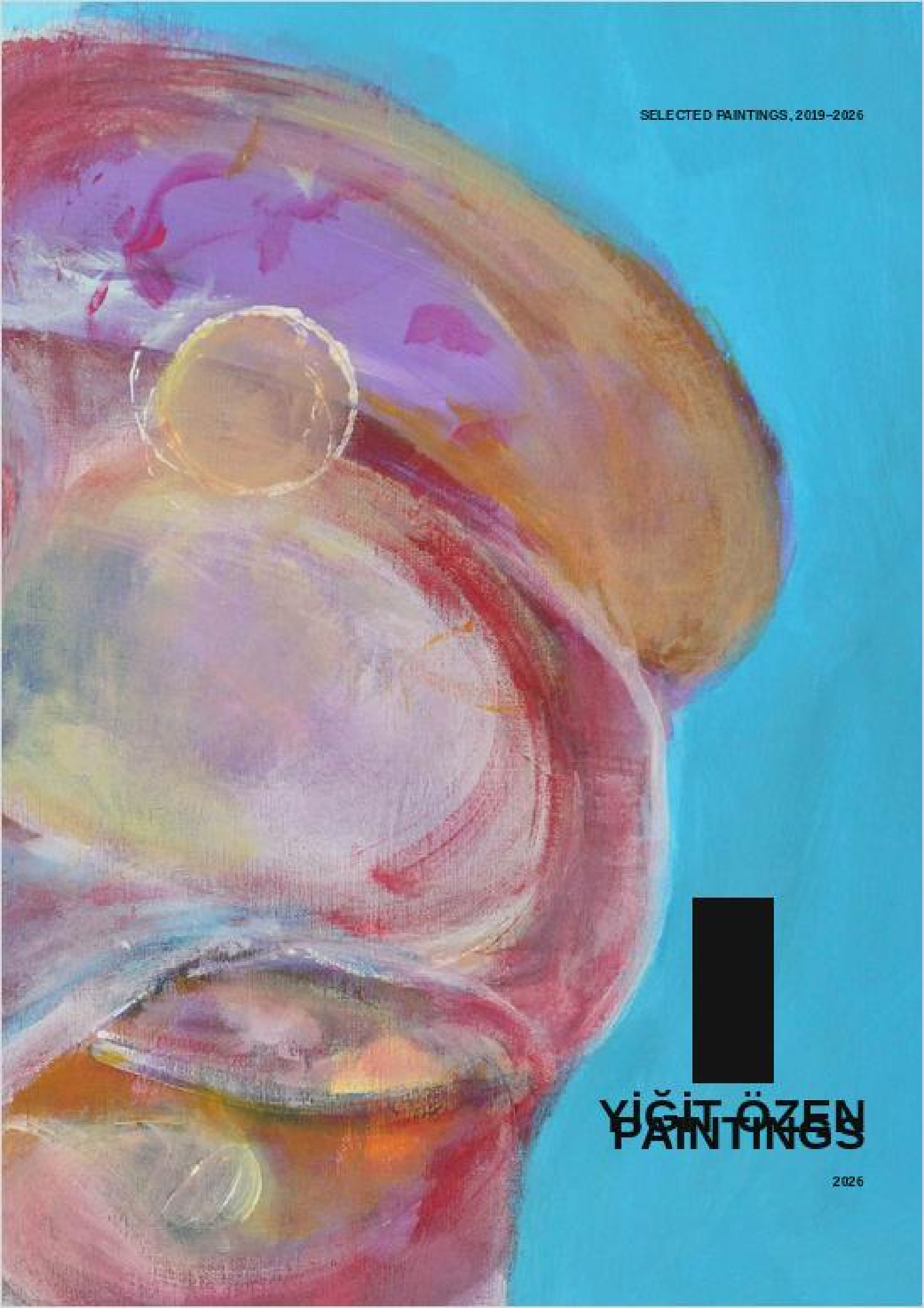




SELECTED PAINTINGS, 2019-2026

YİĞİT ÖZEN
PAINTINGS

2026

Thirteen□paintings

2019–2026 · ISTANBUL, MILAN AND LUXEMBOURG

Paintings□since□2019

Thirteen paintings made since 2019 across Istanbul, Milan and Luxembourg: acrylic on canvas, and once on black paper. They are given here newest first, and a small figure with crossed eyes runs through them from one end of the seven years to the other.

MEDIUM: ACRYLIC ON CANVAS, AND
ONCE ON BLACK PAPER

ORDER: NEWEST FIRST, SO THE SEVEN
YEARS ARE READ BACKWARDS

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THIRTEEN WORKS

NEWEST FIRST

In Oso's paintings a body appears as rounded units settle on top of one another. The contour arrives late and often does not arrive. Scale gives the verdict. A shape held large enough becomes somebody, and the same shape beside it becomes a nose. Most of the ground stays unpainted, and that emptiness decides how far the figure gets to build.

The same parts have been turning up since the beginning. A figure present in the scene and not looking. A chair nobody sits in. A frame drawn over the scene and left open. A bird that arrives under its own power, carrying something never unwrapped. These are working parts. Nothing in them waits to be solved. The one helping and the one crushing are made of the same heap.

Titles do not name the picture. A greeting, a game, a filename, a line taken from elsewhere. They set a second language beside the image and tilt it. Decisions are taken in wet paint, colour is held as a distribution. Over the years the parts stay where they are and the temperature changes.



THIRTEEN WORKS, 2019–2026, READ NEWEST FIRST



Yiğit Özen

BORN 1994, ISTANBUL



Yiğit Özen was born in 1994 in Istanbul and trained as an architect.

Özen has painted since 2018. The thirteen paintings here were made between 2019 and 2026, across Istanbul, Milan and Luxembourg.

From 2020 the studio work went largely to XR and spatial design, and the canvases thin out to one commission in 2023 before the painting resumes in 2026. The years are given as they fall rather than smoothed over.

Alongside the paintings, Özen works as an XR and spatial web designer, and is the founder of decentralised design in Milan and Virtually Eye Alter in Luxembourg.

PAINTER AND SPATIAL DESIGNER

STUDIO, LUXEMBOURG

PAINTING, SELECTED EXHIBITIONS

<i>POWER OF THE NATURE, FABBRICA DEL VAPORE, MILAN</i>	2019
<i>THE ARTS SPECIAL PROJECTS, FABBRICA DEL VAPORE, MILAN</i>	2019

XR AND SPATIAL DESIGN, SELECTED

<i>COMMUNITAS III BY KOLLEKTIV KOLLEKTIV, KUNSTHAUS STEFFISBURG</i>	2021
<i>NEW FREEDOM THINK, MADS GALLERY, MILAN</i>	2022
<i>ART DESIGN, HOLY ART GALLERY, LONDON</i>	2022
<i>DYOR, KUNSTHALLE ZÜRICH, ZÜRICH</i>	2022
<i>CREATORS OF THE METAVERSE BY METAMUNDO, ART BASEL MIAMI</i>	2022
<i>NEW CODES BY VCA, DRAUP AND MAD GLOBAL, ROYAL INSTITUTION, LONDON</i>	2023

TALKS

<i>VCA MENTORSHIP, 6TH COHORT, ARCHITECTURE IN THE METAVERSE</i>	2023
<i>OPENING KEYNOTE, DIGITAL FASHION SUMMIT, CREATIVE DENMARK</i>	2024



THE PAINTING AND THE DESIGN PRACTICE ARE KEPT APART, AND THE RULES BETWEEN THEM SAY WHERE ONE ENDS

2026

SEVEN WORKS · LUXEMBOURG

01

sept neuf

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 55 × 75 CM · 21 3/4 × 29 1/2 IN · 2026 · LUXEMBOURG

The pose is unchanged; the clothes and the manner are not. The café table and its drink have been replaced by a Wiggle and an m13. The eye is a white disc inside a black ring: in Dix the same glass was the claim itself, the document of a woman who looked rather than one who was looked at. Here it is painted shut, and the body has come forward in its place. A bird sits on the stool, drawn with a harder edge than anything alive in the room.

AFTER OTTO DIX, PORTRAIT OF THE JOURNALIST STEVA VON HARDEN, 1926









EVOLUTION OF THE PRINT









7 fam board game

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS - 100 x 80 CM - 30 N x 30 x 20 - 2024 - LUXEMBOURG

One side stands wrapped, each cone clear of the next; the other is stacked two and three high until one head cannot be told from another. Those are the two ways of being a family available on this board, and the game is between them. Nothing has been taken off, so whatever is being played is not the kind of game that ends with a winner. The larger of the two heads has neither eyes nor a mouth; the small one opposite it is all glare.



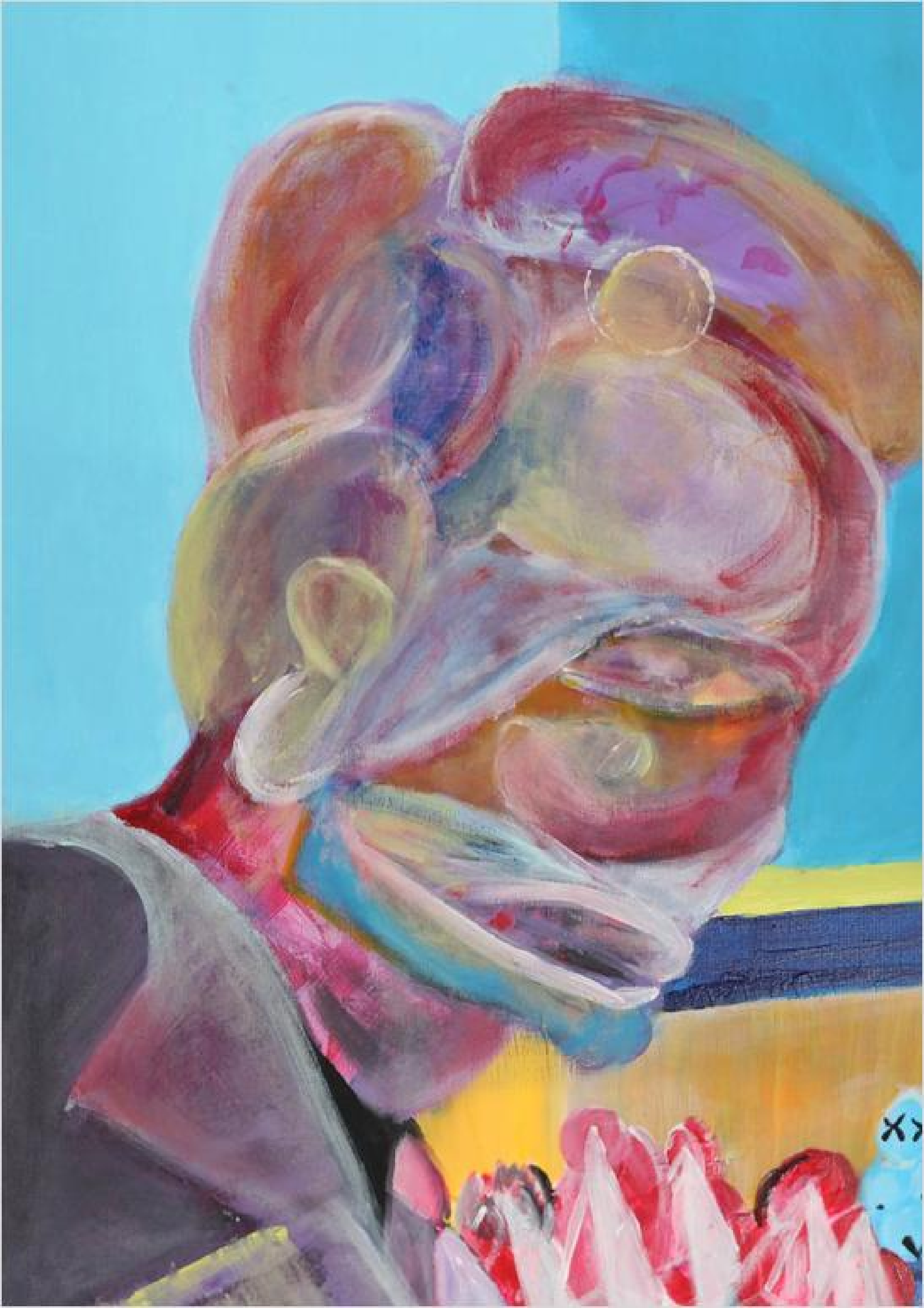






EVOLUTION OF THE EVENT





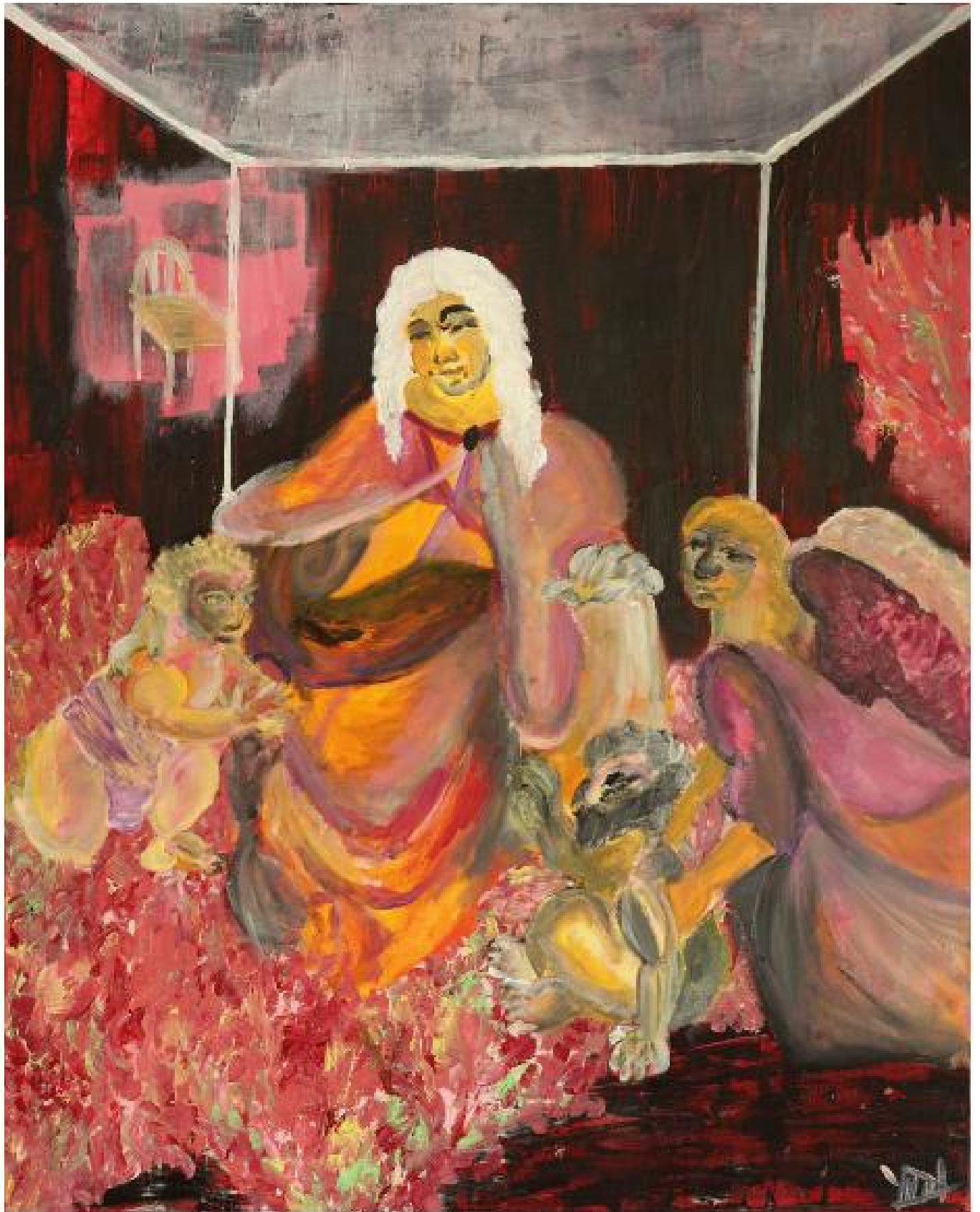




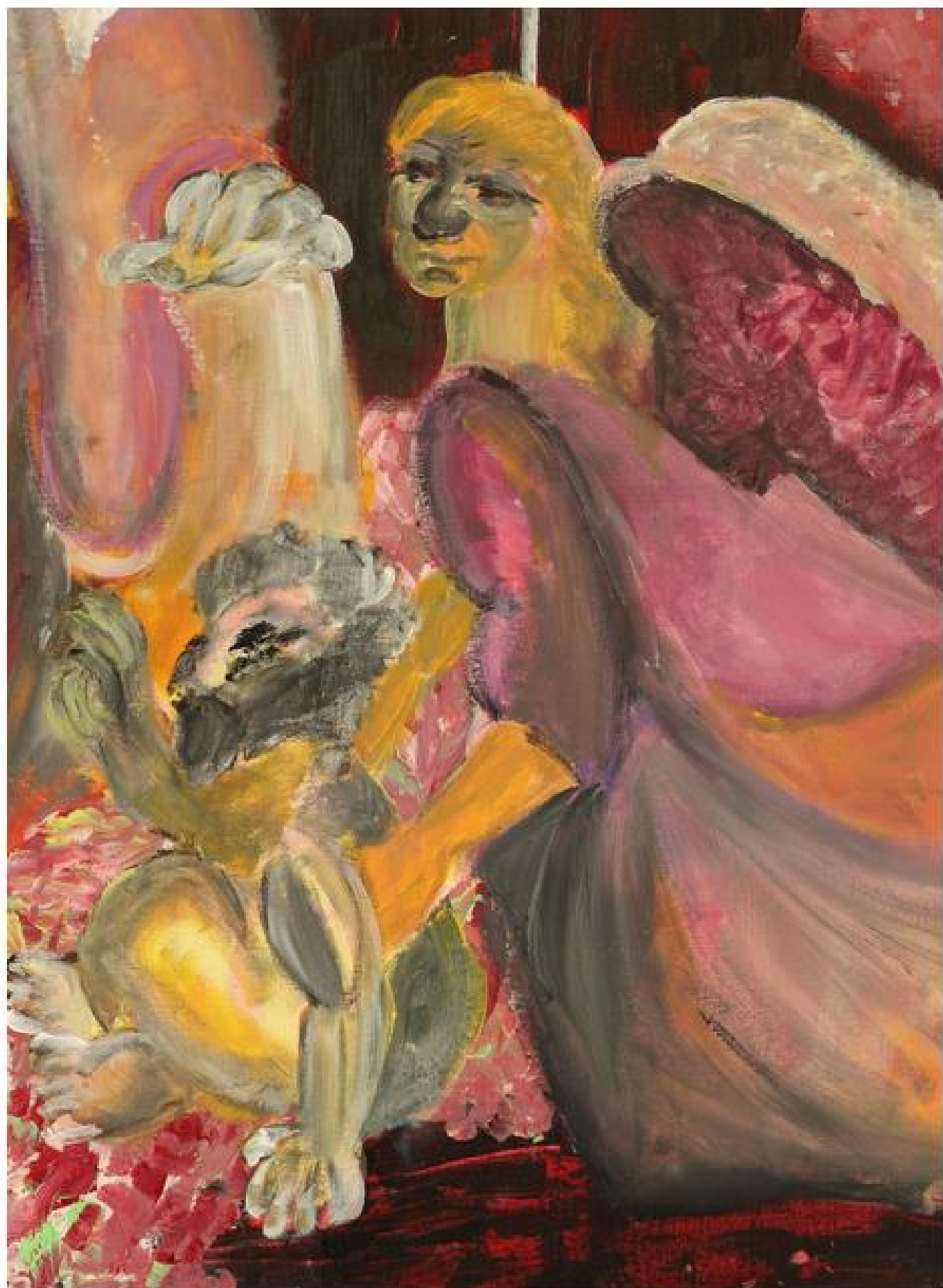
Virgil on Virtual Cage (final_final-final V9)

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS - 80 x 100 CM - 32 x 40 x 30 N. IN - 2026 - LUXEMBOURG

The cage is drawn, not built. A few white lines lay a ceiling, across the top and drop two uprights, then stop two fifths of the way down, so nothing is actually shut in. Underneath, the bodies are soft, pressed from the tube and scratched while still wet, and not one of them looks at the lines. The title carries a guide out of the underworld and a file name that has been saved as final nine times over: two promises of an ending, made by something that has none.























gary grills cooper

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 55 × 75 CM · 21 1/2 × 29 1/2 IN · 2026 · LUXEMBOURG

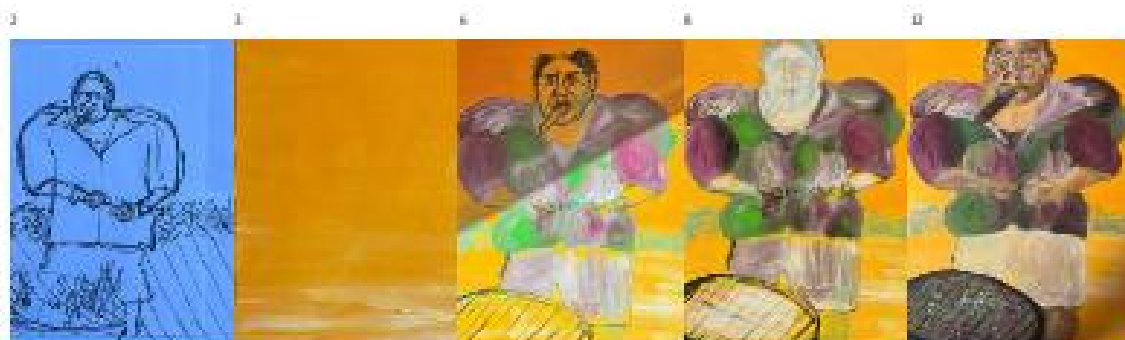
“Whatever happened to Gary Cooper? The strong, silent type. That was an American. He wasn't in touch with his feelings. He just did what he had to do.”

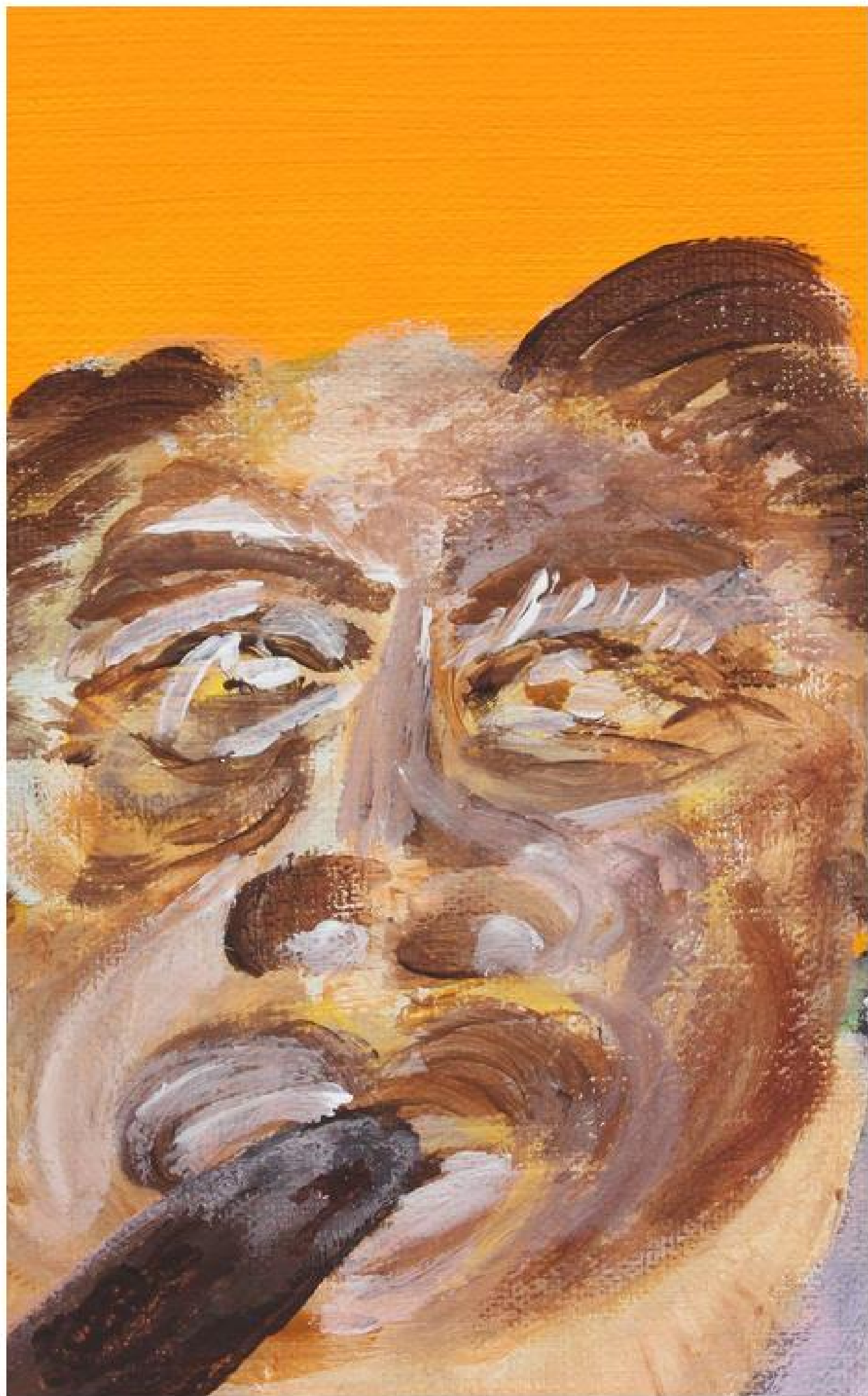
TONY SOPRANO, THE SOPRANOS, JMK, SEASON ONE, 1999





STAGES OF EVOLUTION









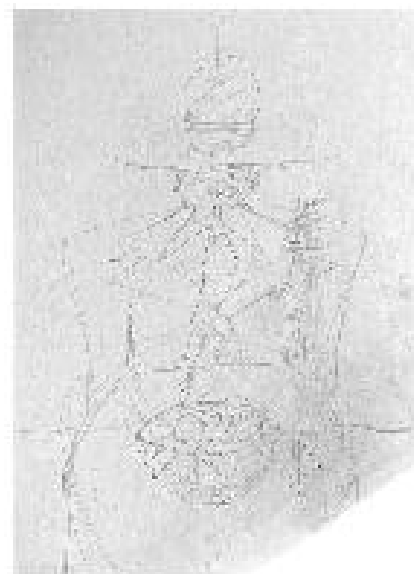
walls of perception

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 50 × 70 CM · 19 1/8 × 27 1/2 IN · 2026 · LUXEMBOURG

What comes out of the mouth is given weight. A column of grains, piled thick enough to cast its own shadow, falls from under the brim into a bowl and is set on the table like something to be eaten. The wall the title names is not behind the figure, it is worn: the brim takes the eyes out of the picture, so the one who is talking cannot be seen to be looking.







articulo attack on mandarin

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS - 80 x 80 CM - 33 1/2 x 33 1/2 IN - 2026 - LUXEMBOURG

The flock is already committed, every wing swept the same way down the diagonal, and the row of figures standing along the boat does not look up. Each of them has an X where the eyes should be, so there is nobody aboard to see it coming. The anchor lies in the corner with its chain beside it. One thin figure at the centre holds the pole, which is the only act in the painting, and it cannot betold whether it is steering or holding on.

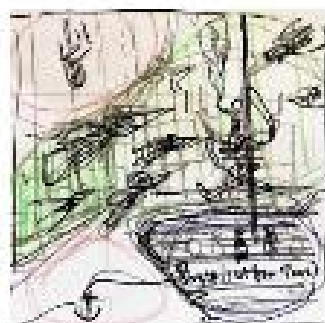


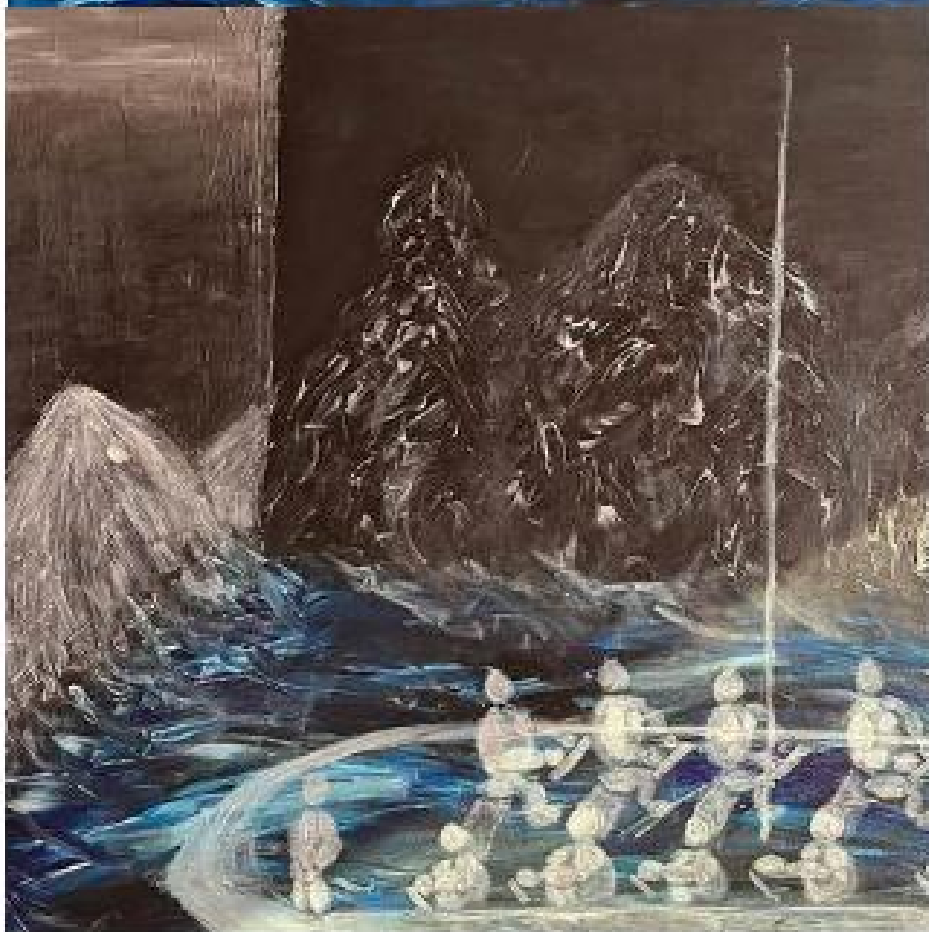












s(t)lop

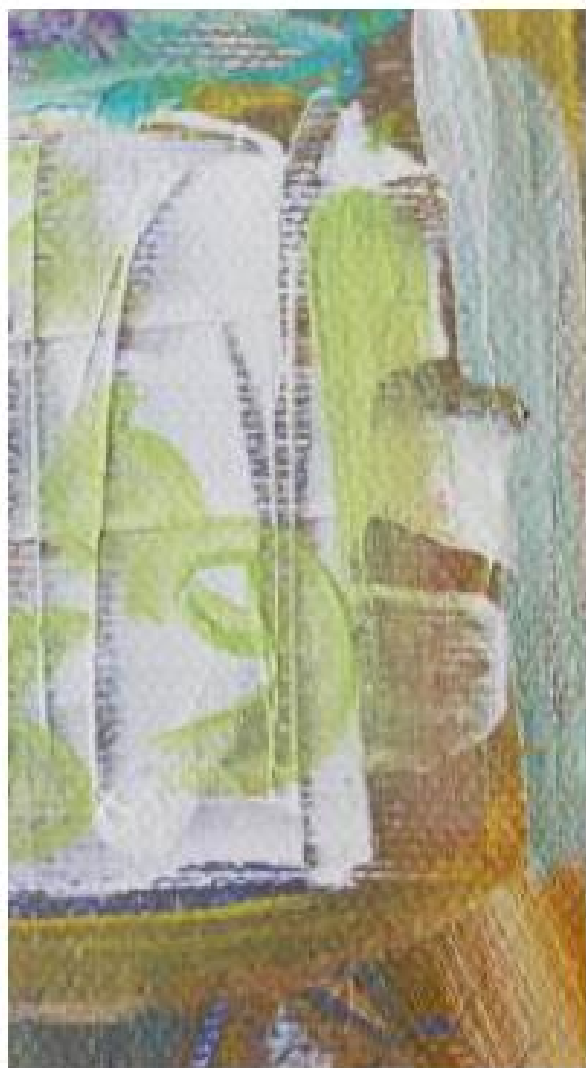
ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 55 × 75 CM · 21 3/4 × 29 1/2 IN · 2026 · LUXEMBOURG

Nothing here separates. The bird and the wall it stands against are made of the same milk, more than one colour on the brush at once, and no contour is ever drawn around the body. The single hard place on the surface is the row of red notches ranged inside the open mouth. Two right angles at the right, a framed panel and a head shut in a box, are all the order there is, and the tide slides between what is fed and what would stop it.









2026 · Luxembourg



2023

ONE COMMISSION · ISTANBUL

08

penguin is not a friend, only a sinner

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 120 × 120 CM · 47.6 × 47.6 IN · 2023 · ISTANBUL (PRIVATE COMMISSION)

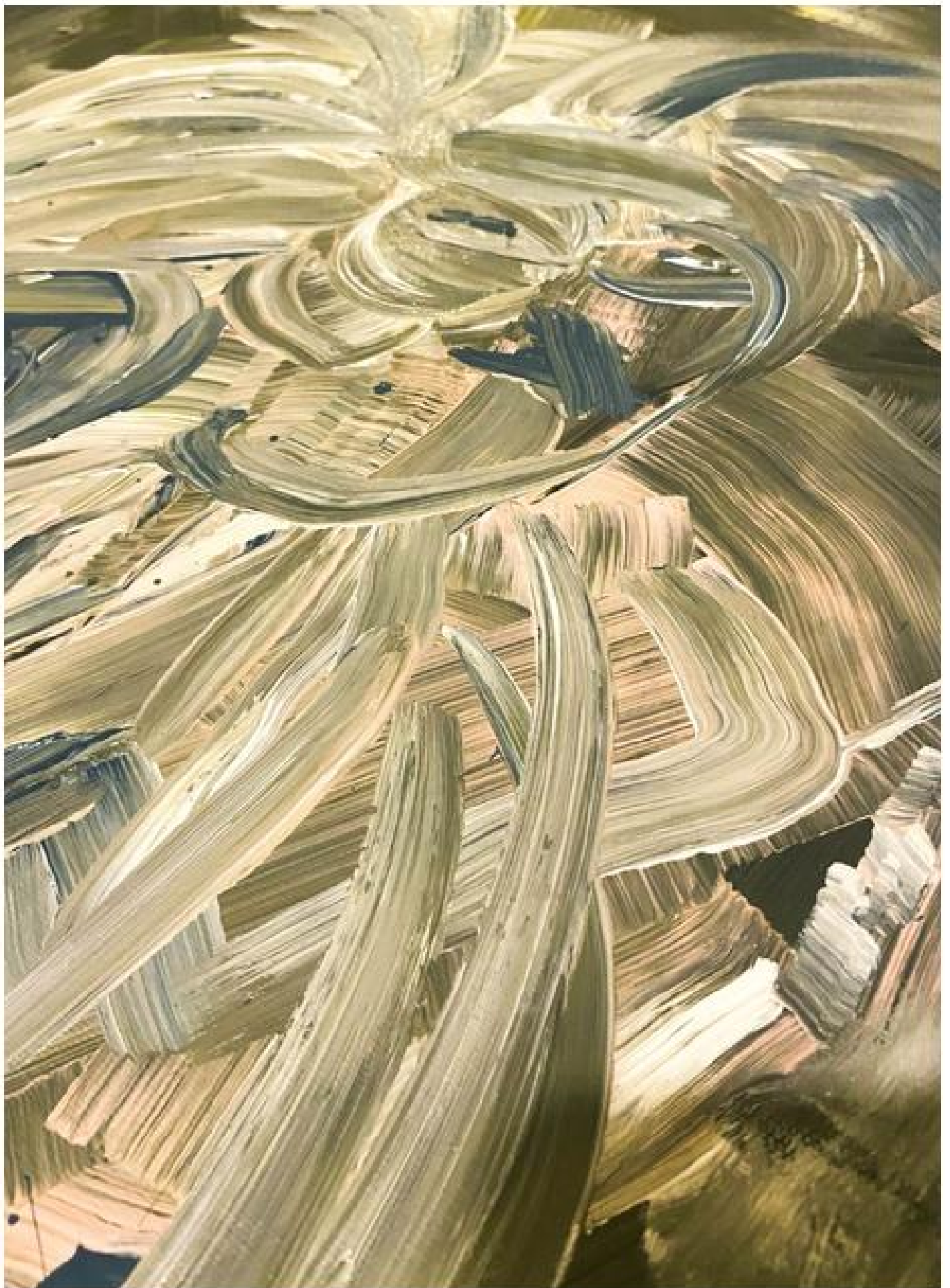
Up at the narrowest part of the body two dark slits have gathered; the face is there, like a small knot fastened to the top of a mass far greater than itself. The great arcs descending below read as an embrace, and also as two taut wings guarding the chest; this double reading sets up the painting's central tension.

From 2020 the studio work went largely to XR and spatial design, and the canvases thin out to this one commission before the painting resumes in 2026.





2023 · Istanbul (private commission)



2020

THREE WORKS · MILAN

09

ciao capo, sono squalo

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 65 x 90 CM · 25 1/8 x 35 3/8 IN · 2020 · MILAN

The painted teeth ranged in the open mouth of the figure on the left stand as the one sharp edge within the softness of the rest of the painting. The title gives this mouth a sentence: hello boss, I am the shark. An Italian and overly cheerful greeting, the opening line of someone introducing himself as a predator.











cellular spleens

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS - 100 x 120 CM - 39 3/8 x 47 5/8 IN - 2020 - MILAN

Below lies a long, flat car, a thick black wheel at each end; it fills the whole breadth of the painting and a large body stands upon it. One foot sunk into the middle of the bodywork, the other braced on its edge, no balance, the stance liable to break at any moment.











caprocorn sister: war, plague, earthquake

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS - 85 x 90 CM - 25 N x 35 N IN - 2020 - MILAN

In the middle of the lower half stands a dark green chest, its edges combed in lines, its lid closed; while everything around it is crinkled, it is the one geometric unit. Three bodies are ranged around it and the title lists three catastrophes side by side: war, plague, earthquake.







2019

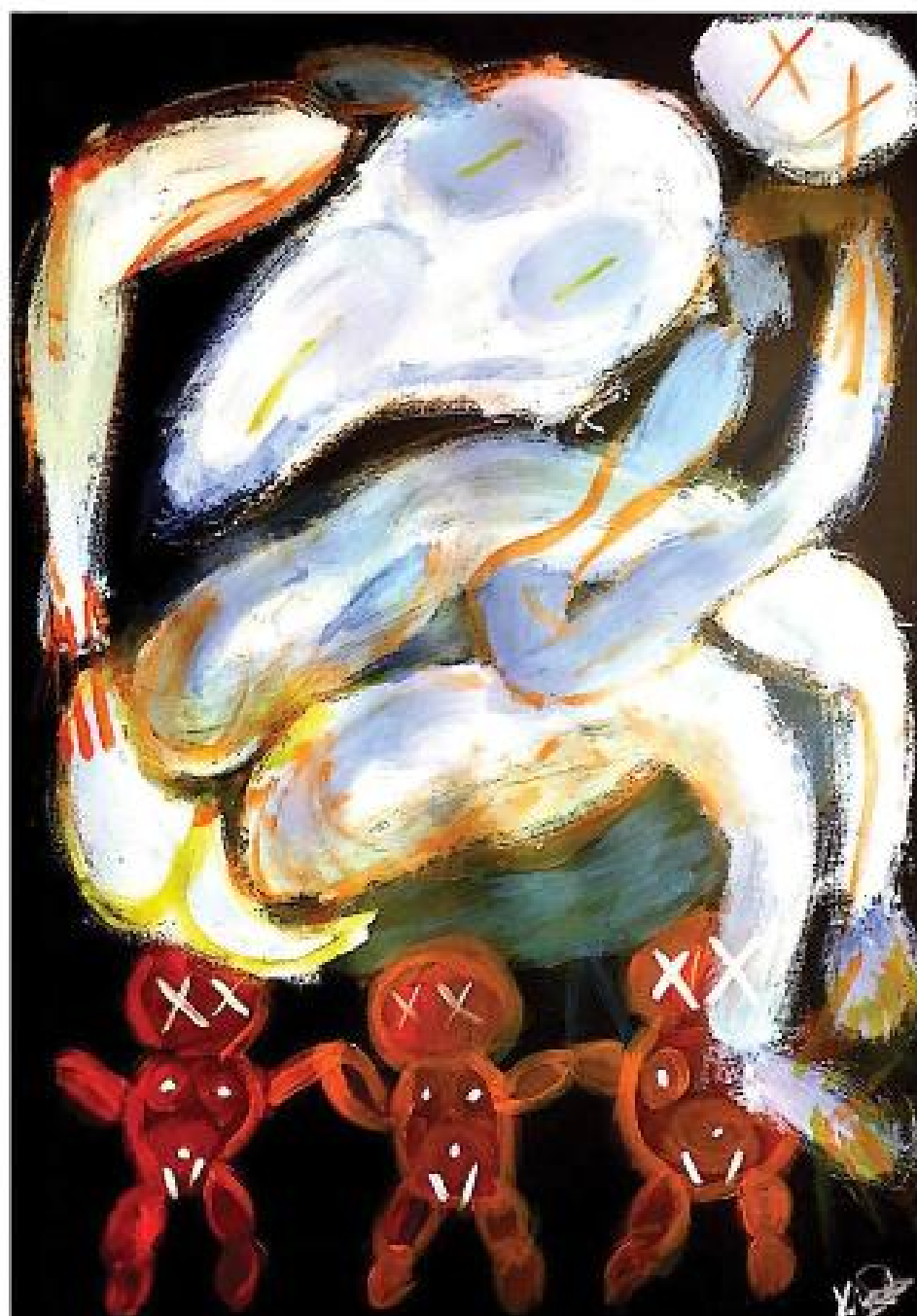
TWO WORKS · MILAN

12

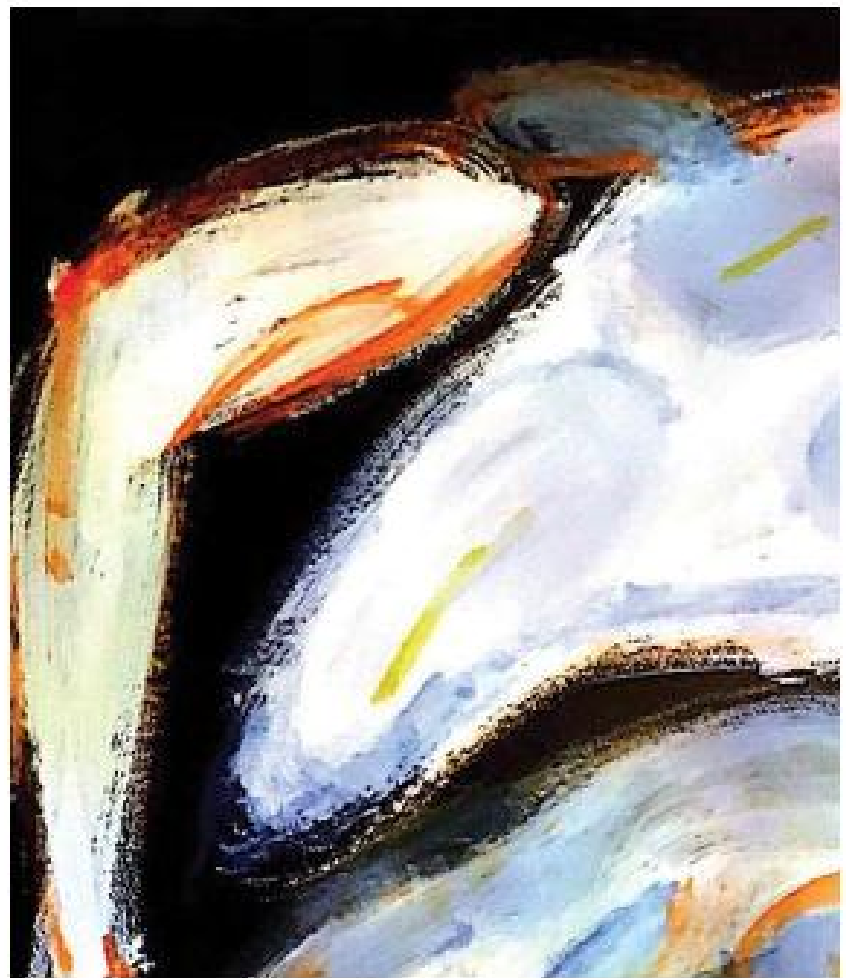
good people helping bad ones (that's why they're bad too)

ACRYLIC ON BLACK PAPER · 70" × 100" CM · 27" × 39" IN · 2019 · MILAN

How many bodies there are within a white heap cannot be counted; an arm rises up, a leg hangs from beneath it, in the middle two mounds resembling a chest overlap and it is unclear whose limb ends where. The one who helps and the one helped, the one embraced and the one crushed, melt into the same mass.







il sbagliato di rompipalle

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS - 85 x 90 CM - 33 1/2 x 35 1/2 IN - 2019 - MILAN

A single neck carries two heads at once; the left one draws near a skull with its teeth ranged in rows while the right one is round, its eyes closed, absent. One dead, one asleep; the shared body binds the two to the same punishment. In the Janus tradition the two faces divide time, one looking to the past, one to the future.





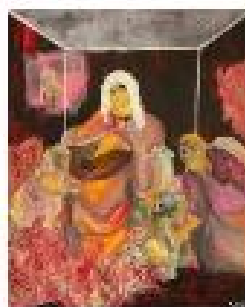




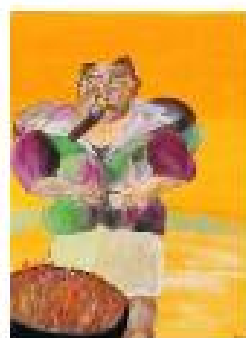
01 • 8



02 • 16



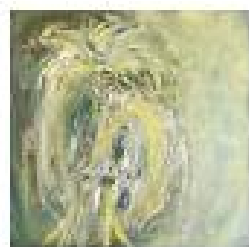
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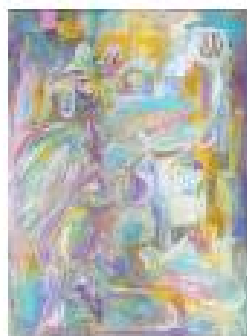
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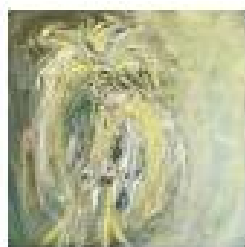
05 • 42



06 • 48



07 • 54



08 • 60



09 • 64



10 • 70



11 • 76



12 • 80



13 • 84

All works by Yiğit Özen, born 1994 in Istanbul and trained as an architect. They are given newest first, so a paragraph that says a thing happens for the first time means the first time reading backwards through the book.

Dimensions are width by height, in centimetres and then in inches.

Photography by the artist. Plates and details reproduce documentation of the paintings; colour and surface differ from the works themselves. The files are set at about 137 pixels to the inch of printed width, made for reading and for screens rather than for offset printing.

Every painting here is followed by details, or by the stages it passed through, or by both.

Where a paragraph gives a proportion or a percentage, it was measured on the documentation file rather than on the painting, and it describes that file. No colour target was used in the photography, so the figures are a reading of the photograph and not a colorimetric claim about the paint.

Titles are set as the artist writes them, in his spelling and his punctuation. *il sbagliato di rompipalle*, *sono squalo* and *capricorn* are his, not slips of the setting.

The epigraph on 04 is credited on the page it appears on.

The details are given without captions; each is a cut from the painting it follows, and each is printed once.

A picture that bleeds is cut by the sheet; every painting treated this way is also printed whole in its own opening and in the index.

The complete book of thirty-six paintings is available on request. All the work is at yigitozen.xyz, where every photograph can be seen at full size.

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THE COVER, MARKED WHERE IT WAS CUT FROM 82 + 7 FAM BOARD GAME

